WholeMind
RESILIENCE

Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy

1. Policy statement

WholeMind Resilience CIC is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of everyone who takes part in our services, including children and young people, and adults at risk of abuse or neglect. Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility, and this commitment applies equally to our founder, board, any freelance facilitators, and any volunteers who work with or on behalf of WholeMind Resilience, regardless of whether the work is paid or unpaid.

We take a preventive, trauma-informed approach in everything we deliver. This policy sets out how we meet that commitment in practice.

2. Purpose and scope

This policy applies to:

- The Founder/Executive Director
- The board members
- Any freelance facilitators or associate practitioners delivering sessions on behalf of WholeMind Resilience
- Any volunteers supporting sessions or events

It covers our work with:

- Adults attending courses, coaching, workshops and any other wellbeing services or other services facilitated by WholeMind Resilience, including adults at risk under the Care Act 2014
- Children and young people in two specific, limited contexts only: (a) sessions delivered within a school setting, and (b) a young person attending a public workshop or session in the company of a parent or carer. WholeMind Resilience does not currently deliver services to children or young people unsupervised or outside these two contexts.

3. Legal and policy framework

This policy is informed by:

- The Care Act 2014 and its statutory guidance, which sets out the duties of organisations working with adults who have care and support needs and may be at risk of abuse or neglect
- The Children Act 1989 and Children Act 2004
- Working Together to Safeguard Children 2026 (DfE, published March 2026), the current statutory guidance on multi-agency safeguarding of children, which explicitly applies to voluntary, community and social enterprise organisations
- The Mental Capacity Act 2005

- UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018, which permit the sharing of personal information where necessary to protect a child or adult at risk
- The Equality Act 2010
- Norfolk Safeguarding Adults Board's Multi-Agency Safeguarding Adults Policy (2025) and model policy for community and voluntary organisations
- NSPCC Learning guidance on writing a safeguarding policy statement for voluntary and community groups

This policy should be read alongside our Code of Conduct, Confidentiality & Information Sharing Policy, Safer Recruitment Policy, and Health & Safety Policy.

4. Definitions

A **child** is anyone under the age of 18.

An **adult at risk** is someone aged 18 or over who has care and support needs (whether or not those needs are currently being met) and, because of those needs, is unable to recognise and/or protect themselves from the risk of, or experience of, abuse or neglect.

Abuse or neglect can take many forms, including physical, sexual, psychological/emotional, financial, discriminatory, organisational, neglect, self-neglect, domestic abuse, modern slavery, and sexual or criminal exploitation. This is not an exhaustive list. WholeMind Resilience does not attempt to categorise every form of abuse within this policy; facilitators are trained to recognise indicators and to escalate any concern through a robust reporting process, rather than to judge whether it meets a formal definition themselves.

5. Our commitment

WholeMind Resilience will:

- Ensure the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL) has current safeguarding training appropriate to both children and adults at risk
- Ensure anyone delivering sessions on our behalf, unless accompanied by a DBS-checked employee or volunteer, holds an appropriate DBS check
- Create an environment where participants feel able to raise a concern
- Take every concern, disclosure or allegation seriously and respond promptly
- Never promise confidentiality when a child or adult may be at risk of harm
- Share information appropriately and in a timely manner with statutory agencies where there is a safeguarding concern
- Review this policy at least annually, or sooner if there is a significant change to our services, an incident, or a relevant change in law or guidance

6. Roles and responsibilities

6.1 Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

Annamarie Gammage is the Designated Safeguarding Lead for WholeMind Resilience CIC, and is the first point of contact for any safeguarding concern raised by staff, facilitators, volunteers, participants, members of the public or other organisations — except where the concern relates to the DSL herself, which follows the separate route in Section 14.

Contact: Email: info@wholemindresilience.co.uk Telephone: 07486 558204

The DSL holds an Enhanced DBS certificate registered with the DBS Update Service, and will complete or refresh safeguarding training appropriate to both children and adults on a regular basis (at minimum every 24 months, and sooner if guidance changes significantly).

The Board are granted permission, and agree, to review the Executive Director's DBS via the Update Service annually, or at any time a concern regarding the Executive Director is raised.

Note on governance: This policy is approved by the Executive Director, with Board oversight, and is presented for Board review annually. Section 14 sets out the specific arrangement that applies where a concern relates to the Executive Director herself.

6.2 Freelance facilitators and volunteers

Anyone delivering sessions on behalf of WholeMind Resilience, or supporting sessions as a volunteer, must:

- Hold an appropriate DBS check before working unsupervised with participants, or before being left alone with any individual or group — Enhanced where the role is legally eligible, otherwise Basic
- Read and confirm understanding of this policy and the Code of Conduct before delivering any session
- Know who the DSL is and how to raise a concern
- Never investigate a concern themselves — their role is to listen, record, and report to the DSL, or refer to Section 14 where a concern pertains to the Executive Director/DSL

7. Safer recruitment

Before anyone delivers sessions or volunteers on behalf of WholeMind Resilience, we will:

- Where unsupervised activity will take place, obtain an appropriate DBS check (via the DBS Update Service where held) — Enhanced where the role is legally eligible (checked using the DBS eligibility tool on gov.uk), otherwise Basic
- Take up references where appropriate to the role
- Confirm relevant professional accreditation (for example, BAMBA-accredited mindfulness training or similar)
- Provide a briefing on this policy and our Code of Conduct before any unsupervised delivery
- Record and track this using the Facilitator & Volunteer Safeguarding Record (Appendix B)

8. Working with children and young people

WholeMind Resilience works with under-18s in two limited contexts only:

1. **School settings** — where sessions are commissioned or arranged directly with a school, and the school's own safeguarding arrangements and Designated Safeguarding Lead take precedence. WholeMind Resilience facilitators will follow the host school's safeguarding procedures for reporting any concern that arises on site, in addition to notifying our own DSL.
2. **A young person attending with a parent or carer** — where a young person takes part in a public session (for example, a community wellbeing workshop) while accompanied throughout by their parent or carer.

WholeMind Resilience does not deliver 1:1 sessions, coaching, or unsupervised group sessions to under-18s.

WholeMind Resilience does not currently offer services to children or young people outside these two contexts. Should this offer expand, this policy will be reviewed for consideration of a dedicated child protection policy and additional training.

9. Working with adults at risk

Our services are frequently accessed by people in high-demand public service roles and by members of the public who may be experiencing stress, burnout, or vulnerability — physical or psychological. Attending one of our sessions does not, in itself, mean someone is an adult at risk under the Care Act 2014 — but facilitators should remain alert to indicators of abuse, neglect, or risk that may emerge during a session, and know how to respond (see Section 11). If in doubt, a referral should always take precedence over inaction.

10. Lone working

Lone working forms part of WholeMind Resilience's delivery model, including 1:1 coaching, community venue sessions, and outdoor sessions (for example, mindful walks). It is anticipated that facilitators and volunteers working on behalf of WholeMind Resilience will normally be working with others, with the Executive Director being the key facilitator identified for lone working. However, this policy applies equally to all staff, employees, freelance facilitators and volunteers. In line with HSE guidance and Suzy Lamplugh Trust good practice on personal safety and lone working, WholeMind Resilience will:

- Complete a risk assessment for any new venue or outdoor location before delivery
- Ensure employees, facilitators and volunteers understand the requirement to share session start/end times and location with a trusted contact, and/or the Executive Director, ahead of any in-person lone-working session, with a check-in arrangement in place
- Ensure the Executive Director's direct telephone number is provided to any person likely to be lone working on behalf of the organisation
- Avoid 1:1 sessions with under-18s under any circumstances
- Ensure freelance facilitators and volunteers follow the same lone working precautions
- Review lone working arrangements as part of the annual policy review

11. Recognising and responding to a concern or disclosure

If a participant discloses something concerning, or a facilitator/volunteer notices signs of possible abuse, neglect or risk:

Do:

- Listen calmly and take what is said seriously
- Reassure the person they were right to speak up
- Explain that you need to share what they've told you with someone who can help — do not promise confidentiality
- Request the town/city or postcode of the person about whom a concern is being raised, unless known to be based in Norfolk, to ensure appropriate services can be contacted without avoidable delay
- Make a written record as soon as possible afterwards, using the Safeguarding Concern Record (Appendix A), noting date, time, and who was present
- Report to the DSL immediately, or the same day at the latest — or, where the concern is about the DSL herself, to Tim Winters directly, following Section 14

Don't:

- Investigate or question the person in detail yourself
- Promise to keep the information secret
- Delay passing on the information

12. Reporting a concern — referral routes

For concerns relating to someone based in Norfolk:

- Immediate danger: call 999
- Adult safeguarding concern: Norfolk County Council Adult Social Services, via the online 'Make a safeguarding report' form at norfolk.gov.uk, or by telephone on 0344 800 8020, following the Norfolk Multi-Agency Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Child safeguarding concern: Norfolk Children's Advice and Duty Service (CADS), professionals' line 0344 800 8021, or the host school's DSL where the concern arises in a school setting

For concerns relating to someone based outside Norfolk (including online clients and organisational contracts elsewhere in the UK):

- Immediate danger: call 999
- Adult or child safeguarding concern: the adult social care or children's services team of the local authority where the person lives

All concerns, regardless of location, must also be logged using the Safeguarding Concern Record (Appendix A), which is kept as a confidential record with a follow-up to confirm the referral has been actioned.

13. Confidentiality and information sharing

Personal information will be shared on a need-to-know basis with statutory safeguarding agencies where there is a safeguarding concern. UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018 do not prevent this — safeguarding is a recognised lawful basis for sharing information without consent where seeking consent would place someone at greater risk. Further detail is set out in our Confidentiality & Information Sharing Policy and our Privacy Notice.

14. Concerns or allegations about the Founder/Executive Director

Because Annamarie Gammage is both the Founder/Executive Director and the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL), a separate, independent route is in place for any concern about her conduct specifically — so that no concern about the person who would normally receive concerns ever depends on that same person to act on it. Any safeguarding concern, allegation, or concern about the conduct of the Founder/Executive Director must be reported directly to Tim Winters, Non-Executive Director, at tim.winters.wholemindresilience@gmail.com — bypassing the Founder/Executive Director entirely. This applies whatever the source of the concern (a participant, facilitator, volunteer, or member of the public).

14.1 What Tim Winters does if a concern is raised about the Founder/Executive Director

1. **Acknowledge** receipt of the concern to the person who raised it, and thank them for reporting it.

2. **Do not investigate.** Do not question the person raising the concern in detail, and do not attempt to establish the facts of the concern itself — that is for the statutory safeguarding agency, not for WholeMind Resilience.
3. **Establish the residential county** of the person the concern relates to, if this is not already known — ask the person raising the concern, or check existing records if appropriate.
4. **Identify and contact the relevant local authority.** In most cases this will be Norfolk County Council. Because WholeMind Resilience works nationally, where the person concerned lives elsewhere in the UK, use GOV.UK to identify the adult social care or children's services team for that local authority, and contact them in the same way described in Section 12.
5. **Record** what has happened using the Safeguarding Concern Record (Appendix A), noting that the concern relates to the Founder/Executive Director and that Tim Winters acted as the point of contact. Once actioned, the completed record is saved to the Safeguarding folder in SharePoint and deleted from the director's own email.
6. **Tell the Founder/Executive Director, and consider next steps as a governance matter — but only after the referral has been made.** A referral to a statutory safeguarding agency must never wait on an internal conversation, a board discussion, or a board meeting. Once the referral has been made and recorded, Tim should inform the Founder/Executive Director and Board that a concern has been raised and referred (unless doing so would itself create a risk).

This does not require a formal board meeting to authorise the referral itself: under WholeMind Resilience's Articles of Association, the Founder/Executive Director cannot be counted in the quorum for, or vote on, any matter where she has a conflict of interest (Article 19.3), and the Directors have separately resolved that Tim Winters may act alone for this specific category of decision (see the Directors' Resolution on Safeguarding Concerns Regarding the Founder/Executive Director, adopted alongside this policy).

14.2 Allegations against other facilitators or volunteers

Any allegation or concern about the conduct of a facilitator or volunteer (other than the Founder/Executive Director) continues to be referred directly to the relevant local authority's Designated Officer / LADO (for concerns about children) or the adult social care team of the relevant local authority (for concerns about an adult at risk), in line with Care Act 2014 guidance on managing allegations against people who work with adults at risk in a paid or unpaid capacity, and reported to the DSL in the usual way.

15. Online and digital delivery

Given the proportion of sessions delivered online, WholeMind Resilience will:

- Use professional platforms (e.g. Microsoft 365/Teams) for all coaching and online sessions
- Avoid personal social media or messaging apps for 1:1 contact with participants where possible. Where initial contact is made via a personal social media account, conversations will be moved to a platform held by WholeMind Resilience, or onto the WholeMind Resilience WhatsApp Business account, at the earliest opportunity
- Record online 1:1 or group sessions only with explicit consent, including consent to use in professional supervision, and store recordings securely in line with our GDPR & Data Protection Policy
- Apply the same disclosure and reporting procedures (Sections 11–12, or Section 14 where the concern is about the DSL) to anything raised during an online session

16. Training and review

The DSL will hold current safeguarding training covering both children and adults at risk, refreshed at least every two years or sooner if guidance changes significantly.

Freelance facilitators and volunteers will confirm their own safeguarding training status before delivering sessions, providing evidence where requested. WholeMind Resilience will provide in-house training covering internal policy requirements, process and documentation to any facilitator or volunteer providing unsupervised services to WholeMind Resilience clientele.

This policy will be reviewed and submitted to the Board annually by the Executive Director, or sooner following any safeguarding incident, a significant change to our services, or a relevant change in law or statutory guidance.

17. Board Adoption

Adopted by the Board of WholeMind Resilience CIC